Only people and machines that really need to make changes to RDS databases should be allowed to do so. The following listing shows an IAM policy that denies all destructive actions to prevent data loss by human failure.

Listing 10.5 IAM policy denying destructive actions

```
{
  "Version": "2012-10-17",
  "Statement": [{
    "Effect": "Allow",                                  ①
    "Action": "rds:*",                                  ②
    "Resource": "*"                                     ③
  }, {
    "Effect": "Deny",                                   ④
    "Action": ["rds:Delete*", "rds:Remove*"],           ⑤
    "Resource": "*"                                     ⑥
  }]
}
```

① Allows access ...

② ... to all actions related to RDS ...

③ ... and all resources.

④ But, denies access ...

⑤ ... to all destructive actions on the RDS service (e.g., delete database instance) ...

⑥ ... for all resources.

As discussed in chapter 5, when introducing IAM, a `Deny` statement overrides any `Allow` statement. Therefore, a user or role with the IAM policy attached does have limited access to RDS, because all actions are allowed except the ones that are destructive.